Decision Sheet: Operations Manual open questions

For: the Graduate School Dean and office. From: Capstone group CAP-IT1. Meeting of 4 November 2026.

Why this sheet: the Operations Manual (Chapter 6) lists 50 open questions. Most are already settled by the Handbook 2022-2023 or are system-design choices the group can make. This sheet keeps only what needs the Graduate School: Part A to decide today, Part B to send later, Part C to tick. Part D needs no action. The full manual stays as the reference; each item gives its question number (OQ-nn) there.

Part A. Only the Graduate School can decide (today, about 15 minutes)

#	Question (manual number)	Group's recommendation	Graduate School's answer
1	Is the Handbook 2022-2023 still in force, with no later edition or memo? Every Handbook-based answer in this sheet rests on it. (OQ-38)	Yes, in force without changes. If memos exist, send them (Part B).	[ ] Agree [ ] Change: _____
2	Does the University accept an approval made in the platform as the officer's signature on the form? May a representative approve for the Dean? (OQ-47)	Accepted for all forms, except where the Research Protocol requires an e-signature on the form itself.	[ ] Agree [ ] Change: _____
3	Data privacy: who is the Data Protection Officer, is consent at first sign-in the basis, and may the outside AI search service receive text? (OQ-48)	The University's officer is named; consent at first sign-in; the outside service stays off.	[ ] Agree [ ] Change: _____
4	Order of the comprehensive examination, adviser and title defense. Handbook p. 57 and p. 58 differ. (OQ-17)	Examination passed before the title defense and the adviser (what the platform does now; the office can switch it off).	[ ] Agree [ ] Change: _____
5	Who approves the research adviser? Handbook p. 58 says the Dean; p. 59 and the Protocol say three officers sign Form 3. (OQ-19)	The Dean, Associate Dean and Research Coordinator decide together; the program adviser is consulted.	[ ] Agree [ ] Change: _____
6	Publication for graduation: required for all, or only for students enrolled from AY 2022-2023? Which journals? (OQ-25)	Required for students enrolled from AY 2022-2023 (Scopus/ISI/WoS for PhD, peer-reviewed for MA); earlier students present at a conference.	[ ] Agree [ ] Change: _____
7	Readmission: the Handbook's four requirements and the platform's four items differ. Who interviews? Is a readmitted student cleared to enroll? (OQ-13)	Both lists apply; the Academic Coordinator interviews and evaluates; enrollment follows the Dean's Advise Slip.	[ ] Agree [ ] Change: _____
8	Withdrawal and drop: who approves, and may a request be refused? (OQ-04)	The Dean approves or denies every withdrawal, with a reason for a denial; a drop needs no approval.	[ ] Agree [ ] Change: _____
9	Is a DRP grade (5.0) a failure that drops the student from the program? Handbook p. 52 and p. 53-54 differ. (OQ-06)	The Dean decides case by case; the platform does not apply the retention rule on its own.	[ ] Agree [ ] Change: _____

Part B. Information to send the group (no decision needed today)

Agree in the meeting who sends each item and by when. Until it arrives, the platform shows the item as "to be confirmed by the office".

Item (manual numbers)	Who sends	By (date)
Fees: withdrawal before classes, changes after week 1, residency enrollment, defense fees and panel honoraria (OQ-02, OQ-15, OQ-27)	Business Office	
Practicum: programs, hours, prerequisites, proof documents, who accepts it (OQ-29)		
Graduation: review window dates, document checklist per program, days allowed to send completion documents (OQ-26, OQ-30, OQ-31)		
File formats: the Registrar's columns and file names, the AIMS export (OQ-32, OQ-50)	Registrar / ITS	
Correct names and mailboxes: ethics office, Turnitin, Graduate School Office (OQ-39)		
Records retention schedule and who approves disposal (OQ-49)		
Subject prerequisites, if any program has them (OQ-44)		

Part C. Group's proposed answers: tick to accept (about 5 minutes)

The Handbook is silent or unclear on these. The group proposes the answer below, mostly what the platform does now. Tick Agree, or write the change.

No.	Proposed answer	Agree	Change to
OQ-03	After week 2, no single-subject withdrawal: the student files a leave or withdraws all subjects.	[ ]	
OQ-05	Drop: arranged with the Academic Coordinator, no form; the Coordinator records it.	[ ]	
OQ-07	Add or change after week 1 only as a documented exception (Associate Dean's written approval).	[ ]	
OQ-12	The platform form counts as the written letter; a pending request may be withdrawn.	[ ]	
OQ-14	AWOL: declared after one semester with no enrollment and no approved leave; counts toward maximum residence.	[ ]	
OQ-16	Maximum residence counted from first enrollment; the Academic Coordinator recommends, the Dean approves an extension.	[ ]	
OQ-18	Missed examination: fee forfeited, re-enroll in residency; the Dean evaluates doctorate students.	[ ]	
OQ-20	Adviser eligibility and limit as in the Research Protocol (newer): five active advisees per academic year.	[ ]	
OQ-21	Form 3 names one adviser who has already agreed; no three-nominee step.	[ ]	

No.	Proposed answer	Agree	Change to
OQ-22	External panel member approved by the GS Research Committee (Research Protocol).	[ ]	
OQ-23	Public final defense: posted 5 days before; panel has the manuscript 14 days before.	[ ]	
OQ-24	Public defense: 30 minutes presentation, 30 minutes questions.	[ ]	
OQ-28	Reschedule by the Research Coordinator with a recorded reason, keeping the lead time.	[ ]	
OQ-33	The Academic Coordinator imports the monitoring workbook each term.	[ ]	
OQ-34	One student counts as a need; the Academic Coordinator decides; a small class is a special class.	[ ]	
OQ-35	The Academic Coordinator decides the offering; the Dean is informed.	[ ]	
OQ-36	Faculty email failures and incompletes to the Academic Coordinator.	[ ]	
OQ-37	Public seminar series and research conference are separate requirements.	[ ]	
OQ-40	Track decided by date of admission (Handbook wording).	[ ]	
OQ-41	Research time limit exceeded: the Dean may extend once.	[ ]	
OQ-43	Two-week rule: the Dean may waive it for a stated reason.	[ ]	
OQ-45	Teaching load at most 24 units, same college only; the Dean approves the offering plan.	[ ]	
OQ-46	The Dean approves staff and coordinator accounts; the University names the Dean's account.	[ ]	

Part D. Already settled by the Handbook (no action)

The platform follows the Handbook as written for: OQ-01 withdrawal window and fees (until week 2; 10% and 20%), OQ-08 weeks counted from the first day of classes, OQ-09 leave of one year renewable once, OQ-10 leave counts toward maximum residence, OQ-11 leave may start until two weeks before the last day of classes, OQ-42 no external member on a project paper panel.

Sign-off

By signing, the reviewer approves the Operations Manual as a working draft for user acceptance testing, with the answers on this sheet. Corrections to Parts C and D may be sent to the group within 7 days of signing; items with no correction by then are taken as accepted. Part B items stay open until the office sends them.

Name	Position	Signature	Date
	Graduate School Dean		